



Above The changing of the guard at Gyeongbokgung Palace – the royal Palace of Shining Happiness – in the north of Seoul



Above Nighttime bustle in the Myeongdong shopping district

A Day in Seoul

Despite Seoul's size, the city's main sightseeing area is small enough to explore on foot. Here you'll find royal palaces, colossal markets, picturesque temples, and countless restaurants, cafés, and shops.

MORNING The majestic palace of **Gyeongbokgung** is at its best in the early morning, when its colorful wooden buildings slowly emerge from silhouette. The northern mountains provide the perfect backdrop, glowing pink and orange with the sun's first beams.

AFTERNOON Seoul is a shopper's dream. Hunt down calligraphic brushes, handmade paper, and artsy trinkets in the traditional stores of **Insadonggil Street**, or head just south to **Myeongdong** for more contemporary offerings. In between runs the gentle stream of Cheonggyecheon, whose quiet banks offer calming strolls.

EVENING It would be a shame to visit Seoul without hitting **Dongdaemun market**, parts of which are open all night. If you've not booked a banquet, you'll be able to pick up rice wine and mung-bean pancakes at the particularly photogenic Gwangjang stand area.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

Flights arrive at **Incheon International Airport**, around an hour away from the downtown by **express bus**. Seoul has an extensive **subway** network, though taxis are remarkably cheap.

WHERE TO STAY

Doulos (inexpensive) has spick-and-span rooms and is ideally located in the middle of the sightseeing area. www.douloshotel.com
Rakkojae (moderate) is a throwback to Joseon times, its wooden buildings set around a beautiful courtyard. www.rkj.co.kr
Westin Chosun (expensive) was Korea's first hotel and retains a gentle elegance, though a stylish overhaul has brought its rooms up to date. www.westinchosun.co.kr

FURTHER INFORMATION

<http://english.visitkorea.or.kr>